



Easy Homemade Cucumber Salsa Recipe for Canning That Tastes Fresh All Year

This cucumber salsa recipe for canning is a fresh and tangy way to preserve summer's best flavors. The crisp cucumbers combined with zesty peppers and herbs make it perfect for snacking or topping your favorite dishes. I love making a big batch in late summer to enjoy all year long!



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15 min
PREP



30 min
COOK



45 min
TOTAL



8
SERVINGS



Easy
DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 6 cups finely diced cucumbers, peeled and seeded
- ☐ 1 cup finely diced red bell pepper
- ☐ 1 cup finely diced onion
- ☐ 2 jalapeño peppers, seeded and minced
- ☐ 3 cloves garlic, minced
- ☐ 1 cup white vinegar (5% acidity)

- ☐ 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- ☐ 1 tablespoon salt
- ☐ 1/4 cup chopped fresh cilantro
- ☐ 1 teaspoon black pepper
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon red chili flakes (optional)

Instructions

- 1** Start by washing and peeling your cucumbers, then remove the seeds and finely dice them. This step is crucial because peeling and seeding prevents the salsa from becoming too watery. Dice the red bell pepper, onion, and jalapeño peppers finely to ensure even flavor distribution. Mince the garlic and chop the cilantro, keeping it aside for later. Preparing all ingredients uniformly helps the salsa have a consistent texture and flavor throughout. ⌚ 15
- 2** In a large pot, combine the white vinegar, sugar, and salt, and bring to a boil over medium heat. Stir until the sugar and salt dissolve completely. This hot pickling liquid is essential as it preserves the salsa and balances the flavors. If you skip this step or don't heat the liquid enough, the sugar and salt won't dissolve properly, and the salsa won't preserve well. ⌚ 5
- 3** Add the diced cucumbers, red bell pepper, onion, jalapeño, and minced garlic to the pot. Stir well to combine. Bring the mixture back to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 5 minutes. This brief cooking softens the vegetables slightly to meld flavors but keeps them crisp. Overcooking will make the salsa mushy, so watch the time carefully. ⌚ 7
- 4** Remove the pot from heat and stir in the chopped cilantro, black pepper, and red chili flakes if using. Adding cilantro at the end preserves its fresh flavor and bright green color, which would otherwise dull if cooked too long. ⌚ 2
- 5** Prepare your canning jars and lids by washing them thoroughly and sterilizing in boiling water. This step is vital to prevent contamination and ensure your salsa stays safe to eat for months. Keep jars hot until ready to fill to avoid cracking when hot salsa is added. ⌚ 10
- 6** Ladle the hot salsa into the prepared jars, leaving about 1/2 inch headspace at the top. Wipe the rims clean with a damp cloth to ensure a proper seal. Headspace allows for expansion during processing, preventing jar breakage or seal failure. ⌚ 10
- 7** Place the lids on the jars and screw on the bands fingertip tight. Avoid overtightening, which can prevent air from escaping during processing and cause seal failure. ⌚ 2

- 8** Process the jars in a boiling water bath for 15 minutes, adjusting time for altitude if necessary. The boiling water bath kills bacteria and seals the jars for safe long-term storage. Underprocessing risks spoilage, so timing is important.  15
- 9** Carefully remove the jars from the water bath and place on a towel-lined surface. Let them cool undisturbed for 12–24 hours. You'll hear the satisfying 'pop' of lids sealing as they cool. Check seals before storing; lids should be concave and not flex when pressed.  20

Chef Tips

 Use a sharp knife to dice vegetables uniformly.

Uniform pieces cook evenly and look more appealing in the jar. Uneven cuts can cause some pieces to overcook while others remain underdone, affecting texture and flavor.

 Keep jars hot before filling.

Adding hot salsa to hot jars prevents thermal shock that can cause jars to crack. It also helps create a better vacuum seal during processing.

 Don't overtighten jar lids.

Lids need to vent air during processing to form a proper seal. Over-tightening traps air, which can cause seal failure and spoilage.

 Adjust processing time for altitude.

Water boils at lower temperatures at higher altitudes, so longer processing times ensure proper sterilization and safe preservation.

 Add fresh herbs after cooking.

Cooking herbs too long dulls their color and flavor. Adding them at the end preserves their brightness and fresh taste.

 Use pickling cucumbers for best texture.

These cucumbers have firmer flesh and fewer seeds, which helps maintain crispness after canning.

☑ Label jars with date and contents.

Keeping track helps you use the oldest jars first and ensures you enjoy the salsa within optimal freshness time.

Storage & Reheating

☑ Refrigerator

After opening, store the salsa in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 2 weeks. The flavors may intensify, but the texture remains crisp. Serve chilled or at room temperature.

❄ Freezer

Freezing is not recommended for canned salsa as it can alter texture and cause jar breakage. Instead, consume within the shelf life or refrigerate after opening.

☑ Reheating

Salsa is best served cold or at room temperature. If desired, gently warm in a saucepan but avoid boiling to preserve crisp texture.

Nutrition (per serving)

40 kcal CALORIES	1g PROTEIN	9g CARBS
0g FAT	1g FIBER	400mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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